

File No.: EXP202205736

RESOLUTION OF SANCTIONING PROCEDURE

From the procedure instructed by the Spanish Agency for Data Protection and based on the following

BACKGROUND

FIRST: Mr. A.A.A. (hereinafter, the complainant) filed a complaint with the Spanish Agency for Data Protection on May 17, 2022. The complaint is directed against Mr. B.B.B. with NIF ***NIF.1 (hereinafter, the respondent), for the installation of a video surveillance system located at ***ADDRESS.1, with indications of a possible violation of the provisions of Article 5.1.c) of the General Data Protection Regulation (hereinafter, GDPR).

The reasons supporting the complaint are as follows:

The complainant states that the respondent is responsible for a rural plot where two cameras have been installed in its outdoor area, facing a publicly used path, without prior administrative authorization for this, having informational signs indicating a video surveillance area where only the name of a security company is mentioned, with no further information.

Images of the camera locations are provided.

The documents submitted are:

- Photographic report

SECOND: In accordance with Article 65.4 of Organic Law 3/2018, of December 5, on Personal Data Protection and Guarantee of Digital Rights (hereinafter LOPDGDD), the aforementioned complaint was forwarded to the respondent, so that they could analyze it and inform this Agency within one month of the actions taken to comply with the requirements set forth in data protection regulations. The forwarding, which was carried out in accordance with the rules established in Law 39/2015, of October 1, on the Common Administrative Procedure of Public Administrations (hereinafter, LPACAP), was acknowledged on May 27, 2022, as stated in the acknowledgment of receipt in the file. Due to the lack of response, the complaint was reiterated on July 12, 2022, and was re-delivered on July 20, 2022.

No response has been received to the forwarding letter, nor to its reiteration.

THIRD: On August 17, 2022, in accordance with Article 65 of the LOPDGDD, the complaint submitted by the complainant was admitted for processing.

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FOURTH: On October 26, 2022, the Director of the Spanish Agency for Data Protection decided to initiate sanctioning proceedings against the respondent for the alleged infringement of Article 5.1.c) of the GDPR, classified under Article 83.5 of the GDPR.

FIFTH: The aforementioned initiation agreement was notified in accordance with the rules established in Law 39/2015, of October 1, on the Common Administrative Procedure of Public Administrations (hereinafter, LPACAP), and after the period granted for the submission of allegations had elapsed, it was confirmed that no allegations had been received from the respondent.

Article 64.2.f) of the LPACAP - a provision of which the respondent was informed in the initiation agreement - establishes that if no allegations are made within the stipulated period regarding the content of the initiation agreement, when it contains a precise statement regarding the attributed responsibility, it may be considered a proposal for resolution. In this case, the initiation agreement of the sanctioning file determined the facts that specified the accusation, the infringement of the GDPR attributed to the respondent, and the sanction that could be imposed. Therefore, considering that the respondent has not made allegations against the initiation agreement of the file and in accordance with the provisions of Article 64.2.f) of the LPACAP, the aforementioned initiation agreement is considered

in this case as a proposal for resolution.

In view of all that has been acted upon by the Spanish Agency for Data Protection in this procedure, the following facts are considered proven,

PROVEN FACTS

FIRST: The complainant states that the respondent is responsible for a rural plot where two cameras have been installed in its outdoor area, facing a publicly used path, without prior administrative authorization for this, having informational signs indicating a video surveillance area where only the name of a security company is mentioned, with no further information.

Images of the camera locations are provided.

SECOND: The Spanish Agency for Data Protection has notified the respondent of the Initiation Agreement of this Sanctioning Procedure, without the respondent having submitted allegations or evidence contradicting the reported facts.

LEGAL GROUNDS

I

Competence

In accordance with the powers granted to each supervisory authority by Article 58.2 of Regulation (EU) 2016/679 (General Data Protection Regulation, hereinafter GDPR), and as established in Articles 47, 48.1, 64.2, and 68.1 of the

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Organic Law 3/2018, of December 5, on the Protection of Personal Data and Guarantee of Digital Rights (hereinafter, LOPDGDD), grants competence to initiate and resolve this procedure to the Director of the Spanish Agency for the Protection of Data.

Furthermore, Article 63.2 of the LOPDGDD states that: "The procedures processed by the Spanish Agency for the Protection of Data shall be governed by the provisions of Regulation (EU) 2016/679, by this organic law, by the regulatory provisions issued for its development and, in so far as they do not contradict them, subsidiarily by the general rules on administrative procedures."

II

The image is a personal data

The physical image of a person, according to Article 4.1 of the GDPR, is personal data and its protection is therefore subject to said Regulation. Article 4.2 of the GDPR defines the concept of "processing" of personal data.

Images generated by a system of cameras or video cameras are personal data, so their processing is subject to data protection regulations.

It is therefore pertinent to analyze whether the processing of personal data (images of natural persons) carried out through the reported video surveillance system complies with the provisions established in the GDPR.

III

Infringement

Article 6.1 of the GDPR establishes the circumstances under which the processing of personal data can be considered lawful.

Regarding processing for video surveillance purposes, Article 22 of the LOPDGDD establishes that natural or legal persons, public or private, may carry out the processing of images through systems of cameras or video cameras with the aim of preserving the safety of persons and property, as well as their facilities.

The processing of personal data is subject to the other principles of processing contained in Article 5 of the GDPR. We will highlight the principle of data minimization contained in Article 5.1.c) of the GDPR, which states that personal data shall be "adequate, relevant and limited to what is necessary in relation

to the purposes for which they are processed.”

This means that in a specific processing operation, only the relevant personal data that is necessary to fulfill the purpose for which it is processed may be processed. The processing must be appropriate and proportional to the purpose it aims to achieve. The relevance in the processing of data must occur both at the time of data collection and in the subsequent processing that is carried out.

According to the above, the processing of excessive data must be restricted or the data must be deleted.

The application of the principle of data minimization in the context of video surveillance implies that images of public roads cannot be captured, since the processing of images in public places, unless there is government authorization, can only be carried out by the Security Forces and Corps.

In some cases, for the protection of private spaces, where cameras have been installed on facades or indoors, it may be necessary to record a portion of the public road to ensure the purpose of security.

That is to say, cameras and video cameras installed for security purposes may not capture images of the public road unless it is essential for that purpose, or it is impossible to avoid it due to their location.

In such extraordinary cases, the cameras may only capture the minimum portion necessary to preserve the safety of persons and property, as well as their facilities.

Under no circumstances will the use of surveillance practices beyond the environment subject to the installation be permitted, particularly not affecting surrounding public spaces, adjacent buildings, and vehicles other than those accessing the monitored space.

The installed cameras may not capture images of third-party private spaces and/or public spaces without a duly justified cause, nor may they affect the privacy of passersby freely moving through the area.

IV

Obligations regarding video surveillance

In accordance with the above, the processing of images through a video surveillance system, to be compliant with current regulations, must meet the following requirements:

1.- Natural or legal persons, public or private, may establish a video surveillance system with the aim of preserving the safety of persons and property, as well as their facilities.

It must be assessed whether the intended purpose can be achieved in a less intrusive manner for the rights and freedoms of citizens. Personal data should only be processed if the purpose of the processing cannot reasonably be achieved by other means, considering Recital 39 of the GDPR.

2.- The images obtained may not be used for a subsequent purpose incompatible with the one that motivated the installation of the video surveillance system.

3.- The duty to inform the affected parties as provided in Articles 12 and 13 of the GDPR, and Article 22 of the LOPDGDD, must be fulfilled, in the terms already indicated.

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4.- The processing of images through the installation of camera or video camera systems must be lawful and comply with the principles of proportionality and data minimization, as previously indicated.

5.- The images may be retained for a maximum period of one month, except in cases where they must be kept to prove the commission of acts that threaten the integrity of persons, property, or facilities. In this second case, they must be made available to the competent authority within a maximum period of 72 hours from the time knowledge of the existence of the recording was obtained.

6.- The data controller must maintain a record of activities regarding the processing carried out under their responsibility, which includes the information referred to in Article 30.1 of the GDPR.

7.- The data controller must conduct a risk analysis or, where appropriate, a data protection impact assessment, to identify the risks arising from the implementation of the video surveillance system, evaluate them, and, if necessary, adopt appropriate security measures.

8.- When a security breach occurs that affects the processing of images from cameras for security

purposes, provided there is a risk to the rights and freedoms of individuals, it must be reported to the AEPD within a maximum period of 72 hours. A security breach is understood to be the accidental or unlawful destruction, loss, or alteration of personal data transmitted, stored, or otherwise processed, or the unauthorized communication or access to such data.

9.- When the system is connected to an alarm center, it may only be installed by a private security company that meets the requirements set forth in Article 5 of Law 5/2014 on Private Security, of April 4. The Spanish Data Protection Agency provides access through its website [<https://www.aepd.es>] to:

- the legislation on personal data protection, including the GDPR and the LOPDGDD (section "Reports and Resolutions" / "Regulations"),
- the Guide on the use of video cameras for security and other purposes,
- the Guide for compliance with the duty to inform (both available in the "Guides and Tools" section).

It is also of interest, in cases of low-risk data processing, the free tool Facilita (in the "Guides and Tools" section), which, through specific questions, allows the data controller to assess their situation regarding the personal data processing they carry out, and if applicable, generate various documents, informative and contractual clauses, as well as an annex with indicative minimum security measures.

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Administrative Infraction

In accordance with the proven facts established during the sanctioning procedure, it is considered that the facts presented violate the provisions of Article 5.1.c) of the GDPR, which could constitute an infraction classified under Article 83.5 of the GDPR, which states the following:

“Violations of the following provisions shall be sanctioned, in accordance with paragraph 2, with administrative fines of up to 20,000,000 EUR or, in the case of an enterprise, an amount equivalent to 4% of the total annual global turnover of the previous financial year, opting for the higher amount:

a) the basic principles for processing, including the conditions for consent under Articles 5, 6, 7, and 9; For the purposes of the statute of limitations for infractions, the infraction indicated in the previous paragraph is considered very serious in accordance with Article 72.1 of the LOPDGDD, which establishes that:

“Based on what is established in Article 83.5 of Regulation (EU) 2016/679, the following are considered very serious and shall prescribe after three years: infractions that constitute a substantial violation of the articles mentioned therein and, in particular, the following:

a) The processing of personal data violating the principles and guarantees established in Article 5 of Regulation (EU) 2016/679.

VI

Sanction

Article 58.2 of the GDPR establishes:

“Each supervisory authority shall have all of the following corrective powers indicated below:

(...)

d) order the controller or processor to bring processing operations into compliance with the provisions of this Regulation, when appropriate, in a specific manner and within a specified timeframe;

(...)

i) impose an administrative fine in accordance with Article 83, in addition to or instead of the measures mentioned in this section, depending on the circumstances of each particular case.”

According to the provisions of Article 83.2 of the GDPR, the measure provided for in Article 58.2 d) of the aforementioned Regulation is compatible with the sanction consisting of an administrative fine.

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Regarding the infringement of Article 5.1.c) of the GDPR, based on the established facts, it is considered that the sanction to be imposed is an administrative fine.

The fine imposed must be, in each individual case, effective, proportionate, and dissuasive, in accordance with the provisions of Article 83.1 of the GDPR.

In order to determine the administrative fine to be imposed, the provisions of Article 83.2 of the GDPR must be observed, which states:

“2. Administrative fines shall be imposed, depending on the circumstances of each individual case, as an additional or substitute measure for the measures provided for in Article 58, paragraph 2, letters a) to h) and j). In deciding on the imposition of an administrative fine and its amount in each individual case, the following shall be duly taken into account:

- a) the nature, gravity, and duration of the infringement, taking into account the nature, scope, or purpose of the processing operation in question, as well as the number of data subjects affected and the level of damage suffered;
- b) the intentionality or negligence in the infringement;
- c) any measures taken by the controller or processor to mitigate the damage suffered by the data subjects;
- d) the degree of responsibility of the controller or processor, taking into account the technical or organizational measures they have implemented pursuant to Articles 25 and 32;
- e) any previous infringements committed by the controller or processor;
- f) the degree of cooperation with the supervisory authority in order to remedy the infringement and mitigate the possible adverse effects of the infringement;
- g) the categories of personal data affected by the infringement;
- h) the manner in which the supervisory authority became aware of the infringement, in particular whether the controller or processor notified the infringement and, if so, to what extent;
- i) when the measures indicated in Article 58, paragraph 2, have previously been ordered against the controller or processor in relation to the same matter, compliance with those measures;
- j) adherence to codes of conduct under Article 40 or to certification mechanisms approved under Article 42,
- k) any other aggravating or mitigating factor applicable to the circumstances of the case, such as the financial benefits obtained or the losses avoided, directly or indirectly, through the infringement.”

In relation to letter k) of Article 83.2 of the GDPR, the LOPDGDD, in its Article 76, “Sanctions and corrective measures,” provides:

“1. The sanctions provided for in paragraphs 4, 5, and 6 of Article 83 of Regulation (EU) 2016/679 shall be applied taking into account the criteria for graduation established in paragraph 2 of the aforementioned article.

2. In accordance with the provisions of Article 83.2.k) of Regulation (EU) 2016/679, the following may also be taken into account:

- a) The continued nature of the infringement.
- b) The connection of the infringer's activity with the processing of personal data.
- c) The benefits obtained as a result of the commission of the infringement.
- d) The possibility that the conduct of the affected party may have contributed to the commission of the infringement.
- e) The existence of a merger by absorption after the commission of the infringement, which cannot be attributed to the absorbing entity.
- f) The impact on the rights of minors.
- g) Having, when not mandatory, a data protection officer.
- h) The voluntary submission by the controller or processor to alternative dispute resolution mechanisms, in cases where there are disputes between them and any data subject.”

The balance of the circumstances considered, regarding the infringement of Article 5.1 c) of the GDPR, allows for the imposition of a fine of €300 (three hundred euros).

Measures

The text of the resolution establishes what the infringements committed were and the facts that led to the violation of data protection regulations, from which it is clearly inferred what measures are to be adopted, without prejudice to the fact that the type of procedures, mechanisms, or specific instruments for implementing them corresponds to the sanctioned party, as it is the controller who fully knows their organization and must decide, based on proactive responsibility and a risk-based approach, how to comply with the GDPR and the LOPDGDD.

It is warned that failure to comply with the requirements of this body may be considered an administrative infringement in accordance with the provisions of the GDPR, classified as an infringement in its Articles 83.5 and 83.6, and such conduct may lead to the initiation of further administrative sanctioning procedures.

VIII

Conclusion

Therefore, in accordance with the applicable legislation and having assessed the criteria for the graduation of the sanctions whose existence has been established, the Director of the Spanish Data Protection Agency RESOLVES:

FIRST: TO IMPOSE on Mr. B.B.B., with NIF ***NIF.1, for an infringement of Article 5.1.c) of the GDPR, classified under Article 83.5 of the GDPR, a fine of 300 euros (THREE HUNDRED euros).

SECOND: TO ORDER Mr. B.B.B. to, pursuant to Article 58.2 d) of the GDPR, within ten working days, adopt the following measures:

- Provide evidence of having removed the cameras in question, supplying documentary proof with date and time that certifies this fact, or, failing that, certify the regularization of the cameras, in accordance with current regulations, so that they neither record nor capture the public use path.

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THIRD: NOTIFY this resolution to B.B.B.

FOURTH: Warn the sanctioned party that they must fulfill the imposed sanction once this resolution becomes executive, in accordance with the provisions of art. 98.1.b) of Law 39/2015, of October 1, on the Common Administrative Procedure of Public Administrations (hereinafter LPACAP), within the voluntary payment period established in art. 68 of the General Collection Regulation, approved by Royal Decree 939/2005, of July 29, in relation to art. 62 of Law 58/2003, of December 17, by making the payment, indicating the NIF of the sanctioned party and the procedure number that appears in the heading of this document, into the restricted account no.

IBAN: ES00-0000-0000-0000-0000-0000 (BIC/SWIFT Code: CAIXESBBXXX), opened in the name of the Spanish Agency for Data Protection at the banking entity CAIXABANK, S.A. Otherwise, collection will proceed in the executive period.

Upon receipt of the notification and once it is executive, if the date of executiveness falls between the 1st and the 15th of each month, inclusive, the deadline for voluntary payment will be until the 20th of the following month or the next business day thereafter, and if it falls between the 16th and the last day of each month, inclusive, the payment deadline will be until the 5th of the second month following or the next business day thereafter.

In accordance with the provisions of article 50 of the LOPDGDD, this Resolution will be made public once it has been notified to the interested parties.

Against this resolution, which concludes the administrative procedure in accordance with art. 48.6 of the LOPDGDD, and in accordance with the provisions of article 123 of the LPACAP, the interested parties may optionally file a motion for reconsideration before the Director of the Spanish Agency for Data Protection within one month from the day following the notification of this resolution or directly file a contentious-administrative appeal before the Contentious-Administrative Chamber of the National Court, in accordance with the provisions of article 25 and section 5 of the fourth additional provision of Law 29/1998, of July 13, regulating the Contentious-Administrative Jurisdiction, within two months

from the day following the notification of this act, as provided in article 46.1 of the aforementioned Law. Finally, it is noted that in accordance with the provisions of art. 90.3 a) of the LPACAP, the firm resolution in the administrative procedure may be provisionally suspended if the interested party expresses their intention to file a contentious-administrative appeal. If this is the case, the interested party must formally communicate this fact by means of a written document addressed to the Spanish Agency for Data Protection, submitting it through the Electronic Registry of the Agency [<https://sedeagpd.gob.es/sede-electronica-web/>], or through any of the other registries provided for in art. 16.4 of the aforementioned Law 39/2015, of October 1. They must also provide the Agency with documentation that proves the effective filing of the contentious-administrative appeal. If the Agency is not aware of the filing of the contentious-administrative appeal within two months from the day following the notification of this resolution, it will consider the provisional suspension to be concluded.

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